

State of the Web 2020–2025

Tracking Page Weight, Protocols & Security at Scale

Data Source: HTTP Archive • Jan 2020 – Mar 2026

Audience: Web Performance Engineers & Front-End Architects

Crawl Sample Size Tripled: From ~5M to 16M Desktop URLs Since 2020

HTTP Archive continuously crawls millions of URLs; the sample expanded sharply in mid-2022 and has plateaued since mid-2023.



Source: HTTP Archive – State of the Web Report

Desktop
~16M URLs

Mobile
~12.5M URLs

Sharp jump
mid-2022

Median Page Weight Climbs Steadily to ~2,000 KB on Desktop

Total transfer size has risen ~25% over five years; mobile tracks slightly below desktop with a similarly heavy tail.



Desktop Median
~2,000 KB

Mobile Median
~1,900 KB

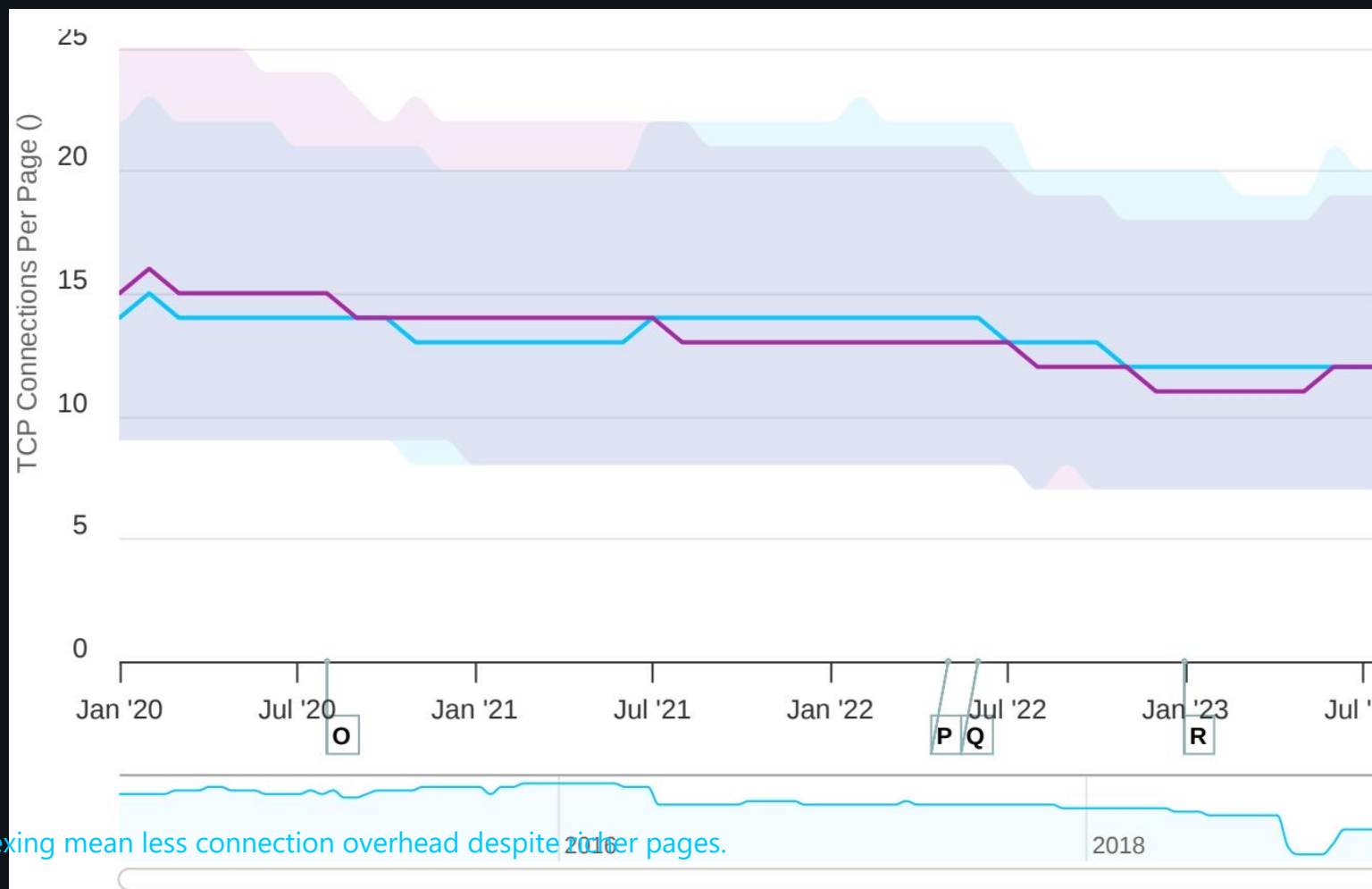
75th Percentile
> 4,000 KB

76 Requests per Desktop Page While TCP Connections Drop to 12

Request counts edge up ~3%, but multiplexing in HTTP/2 and HTTP/3 drives a 15–27% decline in TCP connections per page.

Desktop Requests
76 ▲ 2.7%

Mobile Requests
71 ▲ 2.9%



Efficiency insight: fewer handshakes and better multiplexing mean less connection overhead despite richer pages.

HTTPS Requests Reach 99%: Encryption Is Now the Default

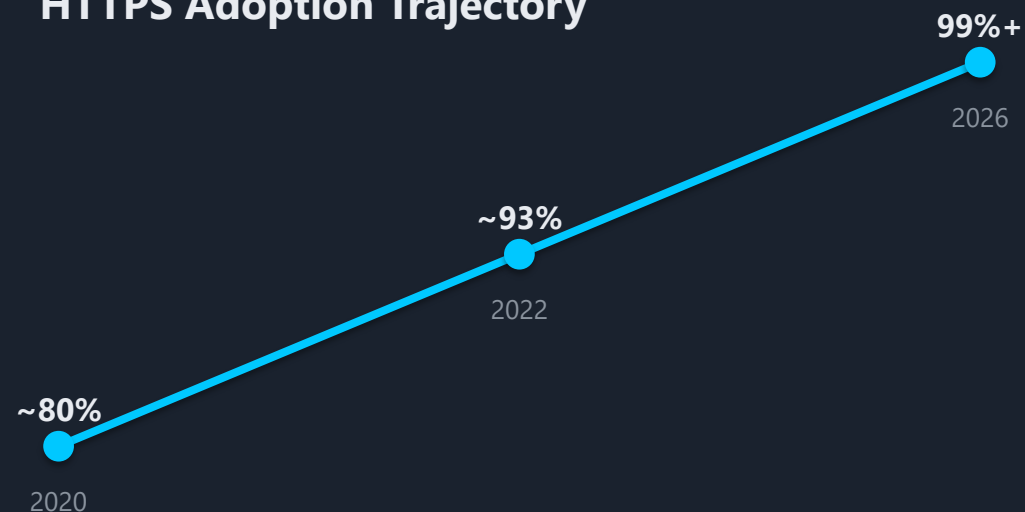
Unencrypted HTTP is effectively extinct on the modern web after a ~19–20 percentage-point climb since 2020.

99%+

Desktop: 99.2% • Mobile: 99.1%

Up from ~80% in early 2020

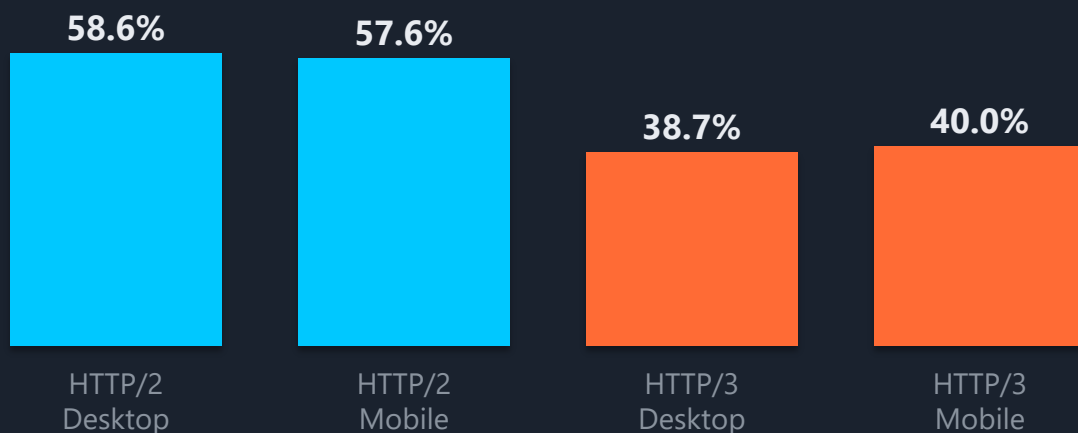
HTTPS Adoption Trajectory



HTTP/2 Holds at ~58% While HTTP/3 Support Surges to 40%

HTTP/2 growth has flattened as HTTP/3 rapidly becomes mainstream. Note: HTTP/3 support is measured, not first-request usage.

Protocol Adoption Snapshot (% of requests / support)



HTTP/3 Desktop
+38,600%

HTTP/3 Mobile
+5,614%

From near-zero baselines in 2020; enormous relative growth reflects early-stage adoption.

Font-Display Usage Reaches 42% on Mobile, Up 61% Since 2020

The font-display CSS property mitigates Flash of Invisible Text (FOIT). Adoption is rising, yet the majority of pages still risk invisible text.

Desktop
40.1%

▲ 14.9% since 2020

Mobile
42.5%

▲ 61.0% since 2020

Insight: With ~58–60% of pages still not using font-display, there is significant headroom for improving perceived font-loading performance.

Key Takeaways: Bigger Pages, Smarter Protocols, Stronger Security

1. Page weight keeps climbing — Median desktop pages now transfer ~2,000 KB, roughly 25% heavier than in 2020, driven by richer media and JavaScript.
2. HTTPS is the new baseline — At 99%+ of requests, unencrypted HTTP is essentially extinct on the modern web.
3. HTTP/3 is the fastest-growing protocol metric — From near-zero to ~40% support in under four years, HTTP/3 is rapidly becoming mainstream.
4. Fewer TCP connections despite more requests — Multiplexing in HTTP/2 and HTTP/3 has cut median connections per page by 15–27%, improving network efficiency.
5. Font-display still underused — At ~40–42% adoption, there is significant room for improvement in avoiding invisible text during font loading.

Call to Action: Benchmark your own sites against these HTTP Archive baselines and prioritize the highest-impact optimizations for your stack.